# Chapter 1

# Mesh generation based on Geompack++

In this document we demonstrate how to generate quadrilateral oomph-lib meshes, based on the output from Barry Joe's mesh generator Geompack++, available as freeware at http://members.shaw.↩ ca/bjoe/. The mesh generation is performed in a two-stage process. First we use Geompack++ to generate the mesh "offline". Then we process the output files generated by Geompack++ to generate an oomph-lib mesh.

## 1.1 Example of the use of Geompack++

The documents meshoper.pdf and regmesh.pdf distributed with Geompack++ contain a comprehensive User's Guide for the code and its many options. Geompack++ is a very sophisticated mesh generator and can be used to create 2D and 3D meshes with a wide variety of element types. Here we only discuss how to use Geompack++ to generate 2D quadrilateral meshes. [The development of of oomph-lib meshes that process Geompack++'s output for other element types should be straightforward but is still on our "To Do" list – any volunteers?]

Geompack++ creates quadrilateral meshes, based on the information about the mesh boundaries (nodes and curves) provided in two input files, filename.rg2 and filename.cs2, say. An output file, filename.↩ 1.mh2 is created. It contains the information about the mesh boundaries, the nodal positions and the element connectivity lists.

### 1.1.1 How to visualise a mesh generated by Geompack++

To visualise the mesh, the program Geomview is available. (Geomview can be downloaded from the Geomview home page .) The Geompack++ output file cannot be processed directly by Geomview but a simple program that converts the file filename.mh2 to a format that is readable by Geomview is available.

### 1.1.2 The example: A rectangle with a hole

As an example we demonstrate how to use Geompack++ to generate a mesh for the rectangular domain with a hole shown in the figure below. The domain is defined by eight nodes and eight curves (straight lines) which connect the nodes and define two boundaries.

The boundary numbers shown in the sketch correspond to those in the Geompack++ input region file box↩ _hole.rg2 and in the curve input file box_hole.cs2. In the corresponding oomph-lib mesh, the boundaries are numbered from zero.

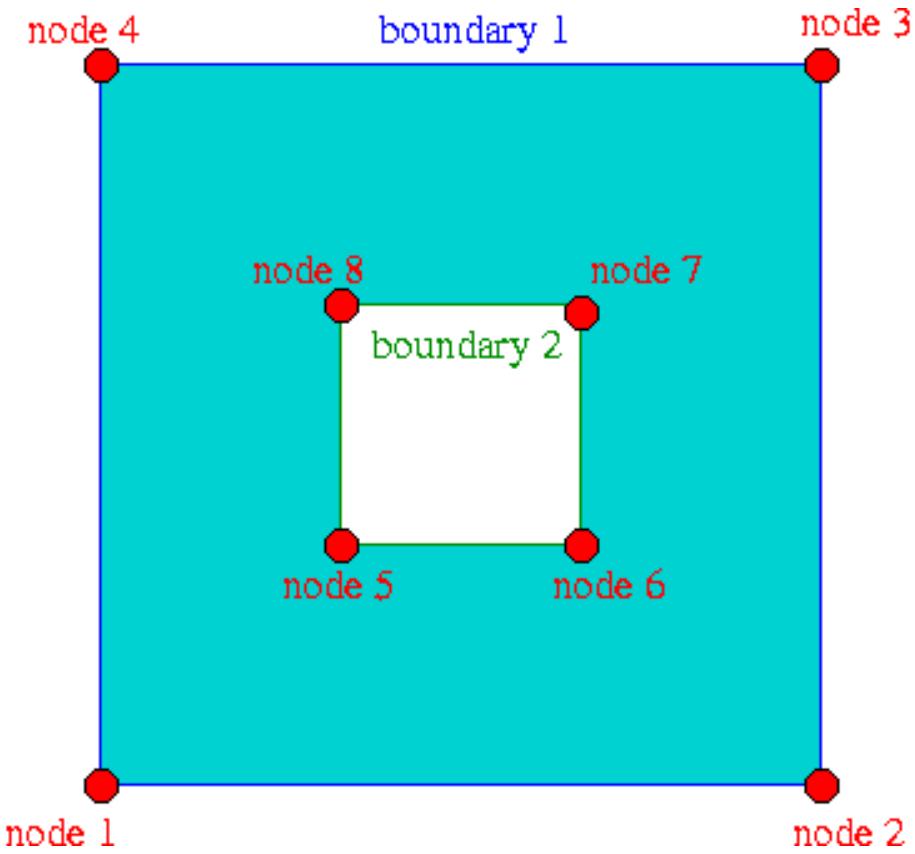



**Figure 1.1 A rectangular domain with a hole.**

The desired mesh characteristics are defined in the file `box_hole.m2` which specifies that the final mesh should contain approximately 200 elements. When processed with the command

```
./geompack++ box_hole.m2 error.log
```

`Geompack++` creates the output file `box_hole.mh2.`

Here is a sketch of the resulting discretisation, as displayed by `geomview` :

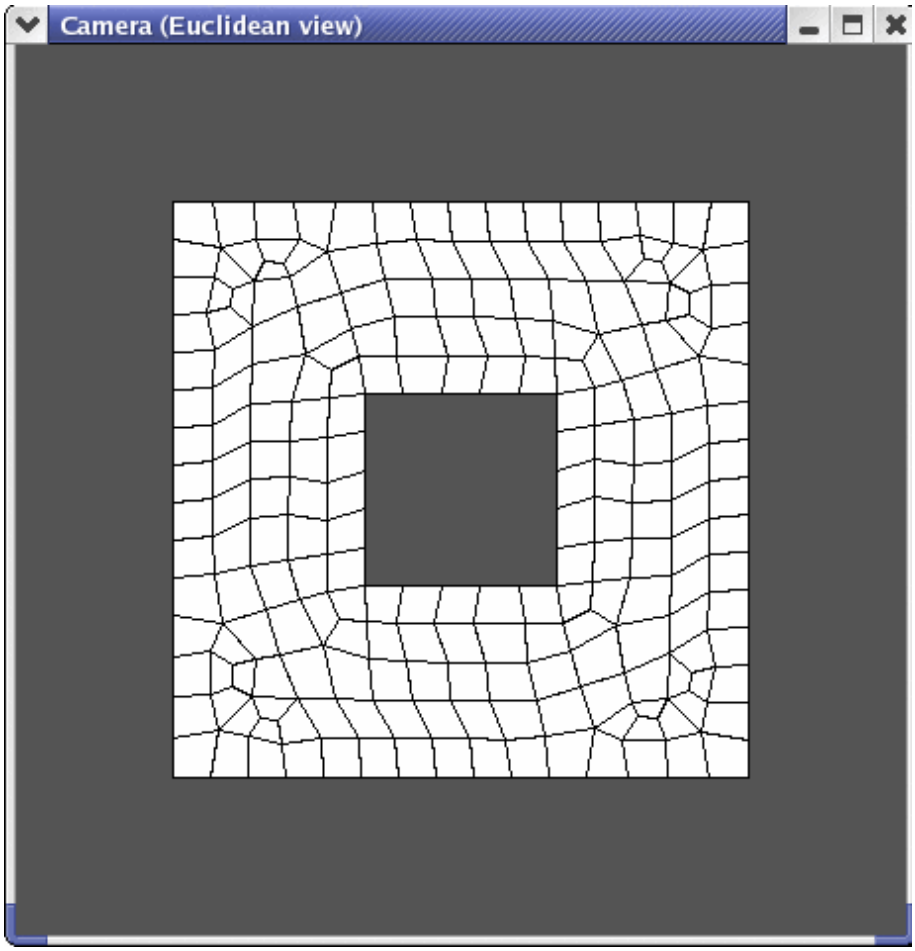



**Figure 1.2 Screenshot of geomview, showing the discretisation of the rectangular domain with a hole.**

## 1.2 Creating an oomph-lib mesh based on output files generated by Geompack++

oomph-lib provides a mesh, GeompackQuadMesh, that uses the output from Geompack++ to generate an oomph-lib Mesh containing QElement<2,2> four-node quadrilateral elements. The relevant interface is:

```
//=========start_of_geompackquadmesh_class==============================
/// Quadrilateral mesh generator; Uses input from Geompack++.
/// See: http://members.shaw.ca/bjoe/
/// Currently only for four-noded quads -- extension to higher-order
/// quads should be trivial (see the corresponding classes for
/// triangular meshes).
//======================================================================
template<class ELEMENT>
class GeompackQuadMesh : public Mesh
{
public:
  /// Constructor with the input files
  GeompackQuadMesh(const std::string& mesh_file_name,
                   const std::string& curve_file_name,
                   TimeStepper* time_stepper_pt = &Mesh::Default_TimeStepper)
```

The driver code mesh_from_geompack_poisson.cc demonstrates the use of this mesh for the solution of a 2D Poisson problem in the "rectangular domain with a hole", described in the previous section.
The code expects the names of *.mh2 and *.cs2 files generated by Geompack++ as command line arguments and stores them in the namespace CommandLineArgs

```
int main(int argc, char* argv[])
{
// Store command line arguments
 CommandLineArgs::setup(argc,argv);

 // Check number of command line arguments: Need exactly two.
 if (argc!=3)
  {
   std::string error_message =
```

```
    "Wrong number of command line arguments.\n";
   error_message +=
    "Must specify the following file names  \n";
   error_message +=
    "filename.mh2 then filename.cs2\n";

   throw OomphLibError(error_message,
                       OOMPH_CURRENT_FUNCTION,
                       OOMPH_EXCEPTION_LOCATION);
  }
```

The names of these files are then passed to the mesh constructor. Since the rest of the driver code is identical to that in the corresponding example with a structured mesh, we do not provide a detailed code listing but simply show the plot of the computed results, together with the tanh-shaped exact solution of the problem:

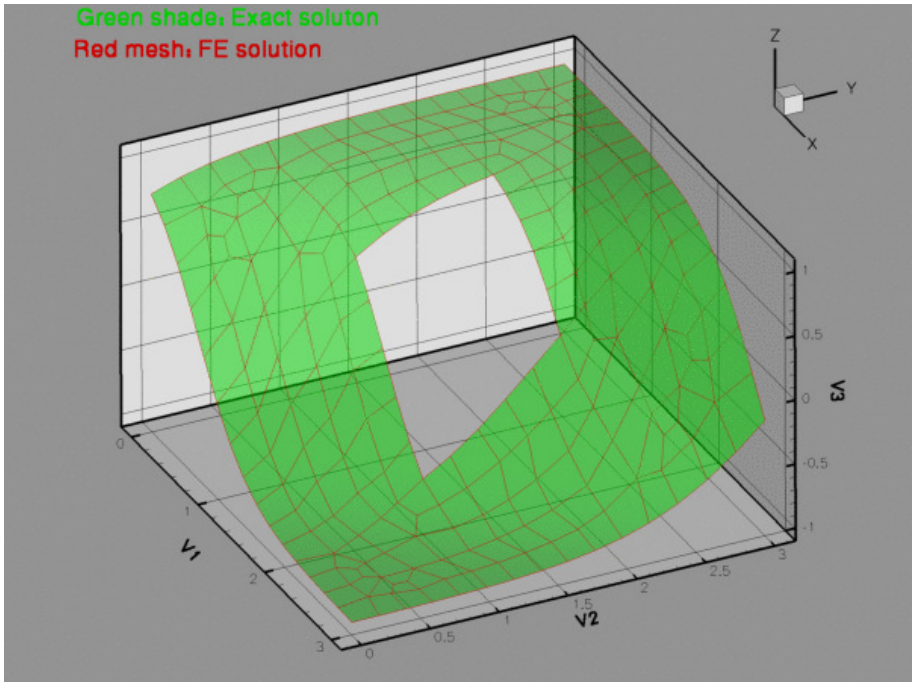



**Figure 1.3 Computed and exact solutions.**

## 1.3 Source files for this tutorial

- The source files for this tutorial are located in the directory:

  demo_drivers/meshing/mesh_from_geompack/

- The driver code is:

  demo_drivers/meshing/mesh_from_geompack/mesh_from_geompack_poisson.cc

## 1.4 PDF file

A pdf version of this document is available. \